# SMART PLACEMENT PREPARATION PLATFORM (PREPSMART)

Submitted for the Partial Fulfillment of the Requirements for the degree of Bachelor of Technology

*in*

**Computer Science and Engineering**

*by*


**Mala Neeraj Srinivas**
**Roll No.: UI21CSC35**


Under the guidance of

*External Supervisor*


**Akhilesh Reddy Karra**

Architect - Application (AuroPro Soft Systems Pvt Ltd), Hyderabad


*Faculty Supervisor*


**Dr. Kaustubh Dhondge**


*Faculty Examiner*


**Dr. Reema Patel**



**DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING**


**May, 2026**


**INDIAN INSTITUTE OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY SURAT-394190**

# Indian Institute of Information Technology Surat
## Computer Science and Engineering Department

# CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the candidate **Mala Neeraj Srinivas** bearing Roll No. **UI21CSC35** of B.Tech. IV Year, 8th Semester, has successfully carried out the major project work titled

**"SMART PLACEMENT PREPARATION PLATFORM (PREPSMART)"**

as an Industry Internship at **AuroPro Soft Systems Pvt Ltd, Hyderabad**, in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of **Bachelor of Technology** in **Computer Science and Engineering Department** at **IIIT Surat**, completed in **May, 2026**.

| | |
|---|---|
| Faculty Supervisor: | Signature: |
| **Dr. Kaustubh Dhondge** | ______________________ |
| Examiner : | Signature: |
| **Dr. Reema Patel** | ______________________ |
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# DECLARATION

I hereby declare that:

(i) This report comprises my original work towards the degree of Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering at the Indian Institute of Information Technology (IIIT) Surat, and has not been submitted elsewhere for a degree.

(ii) Due acknowledgement has been made in the text to all other material used.

**Mala Neeraj Srinivas**
Roll No.:UI21CSC35
B.Tech. IV Year, CSE
IIIT Surat
May, 2026

Signature: ____________________

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**Mala Neeraj Srinivas**

Roll No.: UI21CSC35

B.Tech. IV Year, CSE

IIIT Surat, May 2026

# ABSTRACT


The **Smart Placement Preparation Platform (PrepSmart)** is a comprehensive web-based system designed to streamline and enhance the placement preparation process for students. With increasing competition in campus placements, students require a structured, data-driven, and unified approach to preparation, which is often lacking in traditional methods.

The proposed system integrates multiple components such as **structured learning paths, coding practice, mock tests, AI-based interview simulation,** and **performance analytics** into a single platform. This eliminates the need for using multiple disconnected tools and enables a more efficient and consistent preparation strategy.

The platform is developed using **React** for the frontend, **Django REST Framework (DRF)** for backend services, and **MySQL** as the database. Secure user authentication is implemented using **JSON Web Tokens (JWT)**. The system also includes a real-time Python code execution environment, allowing users to write, run, and test code within the platform.

The backend performs analytical computations such as **accuracy tracking, weak topic identification,** and **progress monitoring,** helping users make data-driven improvements. The AI Interview module simulates interview scenarios and evaluates user responses to enhance both technical and communication skills.

The system is designed with a **modular and scalable architecture,** making it suitable for future enhancements such as cloud deployment, advanced AI recommendations, and company-specific preparation modules.

Overall, **PrepSmart** transforms traditional placement preparation into a **structured, interactive, and measurable process,** significantly improving learning efficiency and readiness for real-world interviews.

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# List of Abbreviations and Acronyms

| | |
|---|---|
| **AI** | Artificial Intelligence |
| **API** | Application Programming Interface |
| **DRF** | Django REST Framework |
| **DB** | Database |
| **UI** | User Interface |
| **UX** | User Experience |
| **JWT** | JSON Web Token |
| **SQL** | Structured Query Language |
| **HTTP** | HyperText Transfer Protocol |
| **HTML** | HyperText Markup Language |
| **CSS** | Cascading Style Sheets |
| **JS** | JavaScript |
| **CRUD** | Create, Read, Update, Delete |
| **IDE** | Integrated Development Environment |
| **NLP** | Natural Language Processing |

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# Chapter 1

# Introduction

## 1.1 Introduction

Campus placements play a crucial role in shaping the careers of students, especially in technical fields such as **Computer Science and Engineering**. With the increasing competition in the job market, students are expected to possess strong problem-solving skills, technical knowledge, aptitude proficiency, and effective communication abilities.

However, traditional methods of placement preparation are often **fragmented and unstructured**. Students typically rely on multiple platforms for coding practice, aptitude tests, mock interviews, and theoretical learning. This scattered approach leads to inefficiencies, lack of consistency, and difficulty in tracking progress.

To address these challenges, the **Smart Placement Preparation Platform (PrepSmart)** has been developed as a **comprehensive and integrated web-based system**. The platform combines all essential components of placement preparation into a single unified environment, enabling students to prepare in a structured and efficient manner.

The system provides features such as **structured learning paths, topic-wise practice modules, mock tests, real-time coding environment, AI-based interview simulation,** and **performance analytics dashboards**. These features help students identify their strengths and weaknesses, monitor their progress, and improve their overall readiness for placements.

The platform is built using modern technologies including **React** for frontend development, **Django REST Framework (DRF)** for backend services, and **MySQL** for data management. Secure authentication is implemented using **JSON Web Tokens (JWT)**, ensuring reliable and scalable user access.

Overall, **PrepSmart** transforms traditional preparation methods into a **data-driven, interactive, and goal-oriented process,** making placement preparation more effective and accessible for students.

## 1.2 Problem Statement

Students preparing for campus placements face several challenges due to the absence of a **centralized and structured preparation system**. The preparation process is often distributed across multiple platforms, leading to inefficiencies and lack of proper coordination.

One of the major issues is the **lack of integration** between different preparation components such as coding practice, aptitude training, mock interviews, and performance tracking. Students are unable to maintain consistency and often struggle to identify their weak areas.

Another significant problem is the **absence of real-time feedback and analytics**. Without proper evaluation mechanisms, students cannot accurately measure their progress or improve systematically. Existing platforms also fail to provide personalized insights, making preparation less effective.

Additionally, there is limited availability of systems that simulate **real interview environments**, resulting in a gap between preparation and actual performance during placements.

Therefore, there is a need to develop a **unified, scalable, and intelligent platform** that integrates all aspects of placement preparation into a single system, providing structured learning, real-time feedback, and data-driven insights.

## 1.3 Objectives

The primary objective of the **PrepSmart platform** is to develop a **comprehensive and efficient system** for placement preparation that integrates multiple functionalities into a single platform. The specific objectives of the project are:

- To develop a **centralized platform** for placement preparation.
- To provide **structured learning paths** for different topics and domains.
- To implement a **real-time coding environment** for problem-solving.
- To design a **mock test system** with performance evaluation.
- To integrate an **AI-based interview module** for interview simulation.
- To provide **analytics and performance tracking** using backend logic.

- To ensure **secure authentication using JWT**.
- To design a **scalable and modular system architecture**.
- To create an **interactive and user-friendly interface** using React.
- To support **company-specific preparation tracking**.

## 1.4 Scope of the Project

The scope of the **PrepSmart platform** includes the design and development of a web-based system that supports comprehensive placement preparation for students. The system covers various functionalities such as:

- **Coding practice** with real-time execution
- **Aptitude and mock tests**
- **AI-based interview simulation**
- **Performance tracking and analytics**
- **User authentication and profile management**

The platform is designed to be **scalable and extensible**, allowing future enhancements such as:

- Integration of **advanced AI-based recommendation systems**
- Deployment on **cloud platforms**
- Addition of **company-specific preparation modules**
- Support for **multiple programming languages in the code editor**

Thus, the system provides a strong foundation for building a complete and intelligent placement preparation ecosystem.

# Chapter 2

# System Architecture

## 2.1 Overview

The **PrepSmart platform** follows a **client-server architecture**, where the frontend and backend operate as separate layers and communicate through well-defined APIs. This separation ensures **modularity, scalability, and maintainability** of the system.

The frontend is developed using **React**, which provides an interactive and dynamic user interface. It handles user interactions, displays data, and communicates with the backend using HTTP requests.

The backend is implemented using **Django REST Framework (DRF)**, which exposes RESTful APIs to manage application logic, handle requests, and process data. The backend is responsible for authentication, business logic, analytics computation, and database operations.

The system uses **MySQL** as the database for storing user data, learning content, test results, and analytics. Secure communication is ensured through **JSON Web Tokens (JWT)**, which handle user authentication and authorization.

Additionally, the platform includes a **local Python execution engine** that allows users to write and execute code within the system. The backend processes code execution requests and returns outputs to the frontend.

This architecture ensures efficient communication between components and supports future scalability, including cloud deployment and microservices-based expansion.

## 2.2 System Architecture Diagram

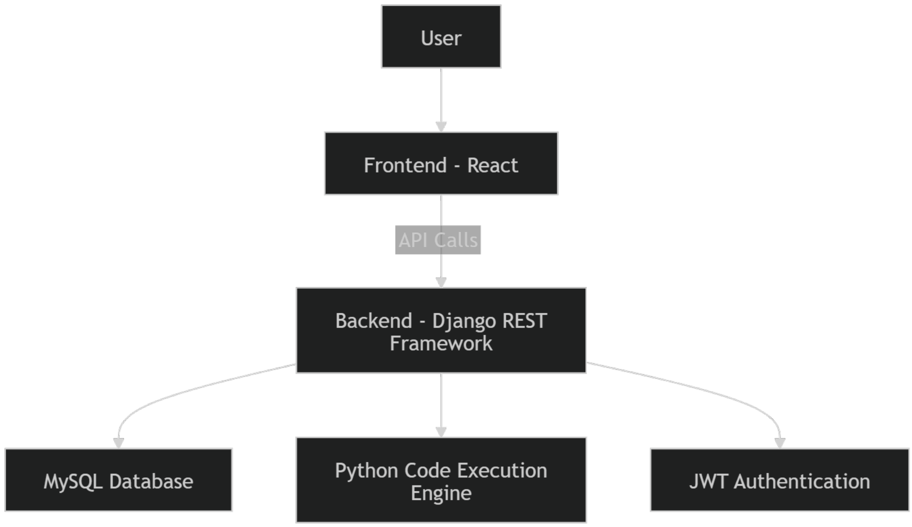


Figure 2.1: System Architecture of PrepSmart Platform

The system architecture of the **PrepSmart platform** follows a client-server model. The user interacts with the frontend developed using **React**, which sends requests to the backend via **REST APIs**. The backend, built using **Django REST Framework**, processes these requests, performs business logic, and communicates with the **MySQL** database for data storage and retrieval.

The system also includes a **Python-based code execution engine**, which allows users to execute code in real-time. Authentication is handled securely using **JSON Web Tokens (JWT)**, ensuring protected access to system resources. This modular architecture ensures scalability, maintainability, and efficient data flow across the platform.

## 2.3 Architecture Explanation

The architecture of the PrepSmart platform consists of three major components: **Frontend, Backend,** and **Database**.

1. **Frontend Layer (React):**
   This layer provides the user interface and handles all user interactions. It includes modules such as login/signup, dashboard, learning modules, mock tests, code editor, and analytics. The frontend communicates with the backend through REST APIs.

2. **Backend Layer (Django REST Framework):**
   The backend manages application logic, processes requests, and controls data flow. It includes authentication services using JWT, API endpoints for various modules, and analytics computation. The backend ensures secure and efficient communication between frontend and database.

3. **Code Execution Engine:**
   The platform includes a local Python execution environment that processes code submitted by users. The backend executes the code and returns the output to the frontend in real-time.

4. **Authentication System:**
   Secure access is provided through JSON Web Tokens (JWT), which authenticate users and manage sessions without storing sensitive data on the server.

The interaction between these components ensures smooth data flow, efficient processing, and a seamless user experience.

## 2.4 Data Flow

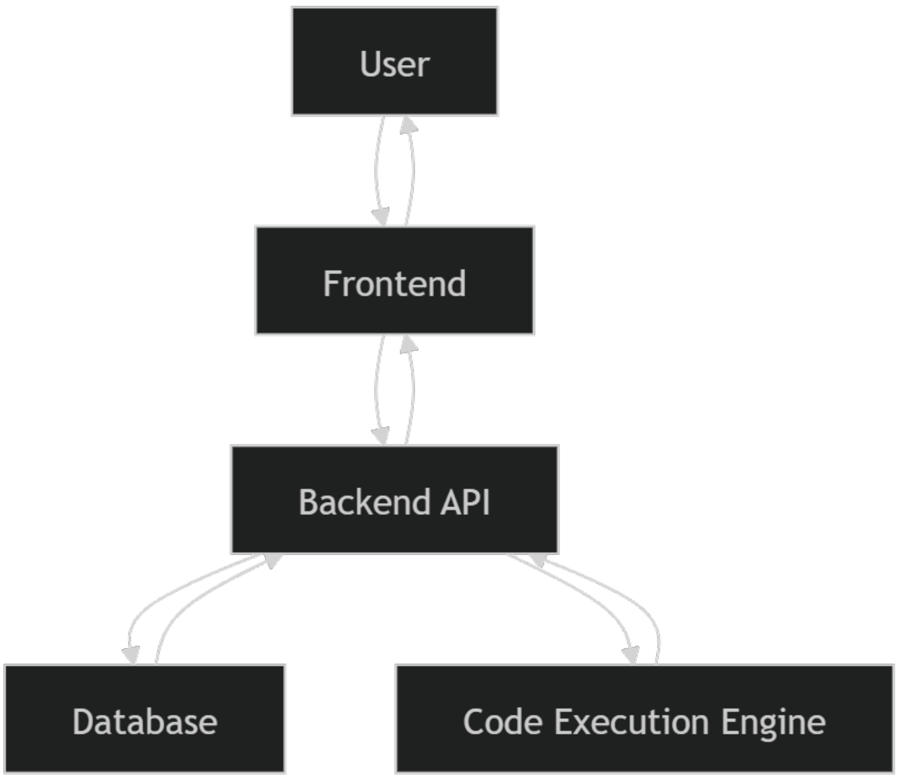


Figure 2.2: Data Flow Diagram of PrepSmart Platform

The data flow in the PrepSmart platform begins with user interactions such as login, practice attempts, or test submissions. These actions are captured by the frontend and sent to the backend through API requests.

The backend processes the request, validates the data, and interacts with the database to store or retrieve relevant information. In the case of coding problems, the backend forwards the code to the Python execution engine and retrieves the output.

The processed data is then sent back to the frontend, where it is displayed to the user. This structured data flow ensures real-time interaction, efficient processing, and accurate performance tracking.

## 2.5 Data Flow Explanation

The data flow in the PrepSmart platform follows a structured process that ensures efficient communication between system components.

When a user interacts with the frontend, such as logging in, attempting a test, or executing code, a request is sent to the backend via API calls. The backend processes the request, performs necessary computations or validations, and interacts with the database if required.

For example, during authentication, user credentials are verified, and a JWT token is generated. In the case of coding practice, the submitted code is sent to the backend, executed in the Python environment, and the output is returned to the frontend.

Similarly, analytics data is computed in the backend based on user performance and stored in the database. This data is then fetched and displayed on the dashboard.

This structured data flow ensures reliability, scalability, and real-time feedback for users.

# Chapter 3

# Technologies Used

## 3.1 Overview

The **PrepSmart platform** is developed using a modern and efficient technology stack that ensures scalability, performance, and ease of development. The system follows a **full-stack web development approach,** where the frontend, backend, and database are designed as independent yet interconnected components.

The frontend is responsible for delivering an interactive and responsive user interface, while the backend handles business logic, API communication, and data processing. The database is used for persistent storage of application data such as user information, test results, and analytics.

The selected technologies were chosen based on their **performance, flexibility, community support, and compatibility** with real-world application development.

## 3.2 Frontend Technologies

The frontend of the **PrepSmart platform** is developed using React, a popular JavaScript library for building user interfaces. **React** enables the creation of dynamic and reusable UI components, improving development efficiency and maintainability. Additional frontend technologies include:

- **HTML (HyperText Markup Language):** Used for structuring web content.
- **CSS (Cascading Style Sheets):** Used for styling and layout design.
- **JavaScript (JS):** Provides interactivity and dynamic behavior.
- **Axios / Fetch API:** Used for making HTTP requests to the backend.

React's component-based architecture allows efficient state management and improves user experience by enabling fast rendering and seamless navigation across the platform.

## 3.3 Backend Technologies

The backend of the PrepSmart platform is developed using **Django REST Framework (DRF)**, which is a powerful toolkit for building Web APIs in Python. Key backend technologies include:

- **Django:** A high-level Python web framework that promotes rapid development and clean design.
- **Django REST Framework (DRF):** Used to create RESTful APIs for communication between frontend and backend.
- **JWT (JSON Web Token):** Used for secure user authentication and authorization.

## 3.4 Database

The platform uses **MySQL**, a relational database management system, for storing structured data efficiently. The database stores:

- User information and profiles
- Learning progress and tracks
- Practice questions and test data
- Analytics and performance metrics

MySQL ensures data consistency, reliability, and supports complex queries required for analytics and reporting.

## 3.5 Other Tools And Technologies

The development and execution of the PrepSmart platform also involve additional tools and technologies:

- **Python:** Used for backend logic and code execution.
- **Local Code Execution Engine:** Allows users to run Python code in real-time.
- **VS Code:** Used as the primary development environment.
- **Git & GitHub:** Used for version control and project management.
- **Postman:** Used for API testing and debugging.

These tools enhance development efficiency, debugging, and deployment readiness of the system.

Table 3.1: Technology Stack Overview

| **Layer** | **Technology Used** |
|---|---|
| Frontend | React, HTML, CSS, JavaScript |
| Backend | Django, Django REST Framework |
| Database | MySQL |
| Authentication | JSON Web Token (JWT) |
| Programming Language | Python |
| Tools | GitHub, Postman, VS Code |

# Chapter 4

# System Implementation

## 4.1 Authentication Module

The authentication module is responsible for managing user access to the system. It includes functionalities such as user registration (signup) and login.

During registration, users provide details such as name, email, password, academic information, and target role. These details are securely stored in the database.

For login, users enter their credentials, which are validated by the backend. Upon successful authentication, a **JSON Web Token (JWT)** is generated and sent to the frontend. This token is used for secure communication in subsequent requests.

The authentication system ensures data security, prevents unauthorized access, and maintains session integrity.

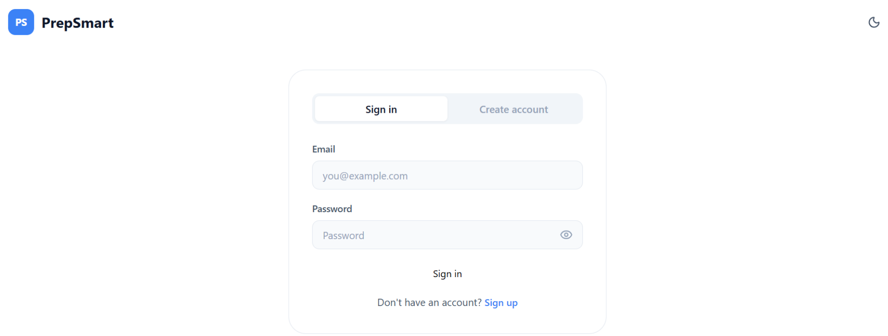


Figure 4.1: Login Page.

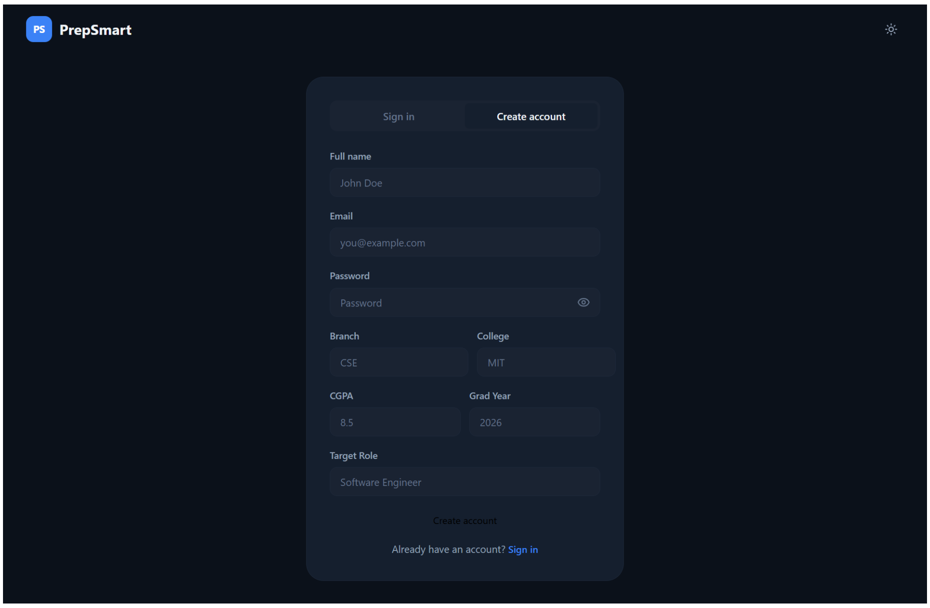


Figure 4.2: Signup Page.

## 4.2 Dashboard Module

The dashboard provides an overview of the user's placement preparation progress. It displays key metrics such as placement readiness, problems solved, day streak, and accuracy.

It also includes sections like daily plans, company readiness, learning tracks, and recent activity. These components are dynamically updated based on user performance.

The dashboard helps users monitor their progress and stay focused on their preparation goals.

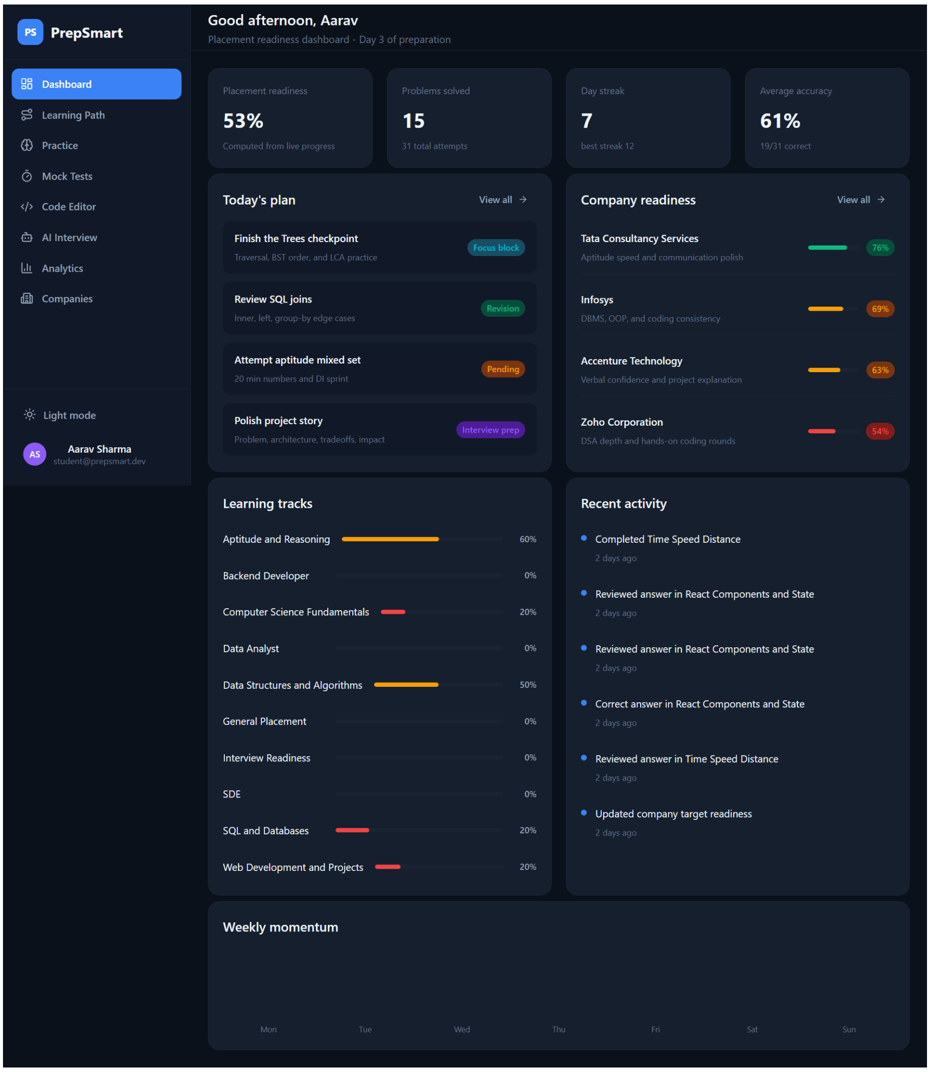


Figure 4.3: Dashboard Page - Overview

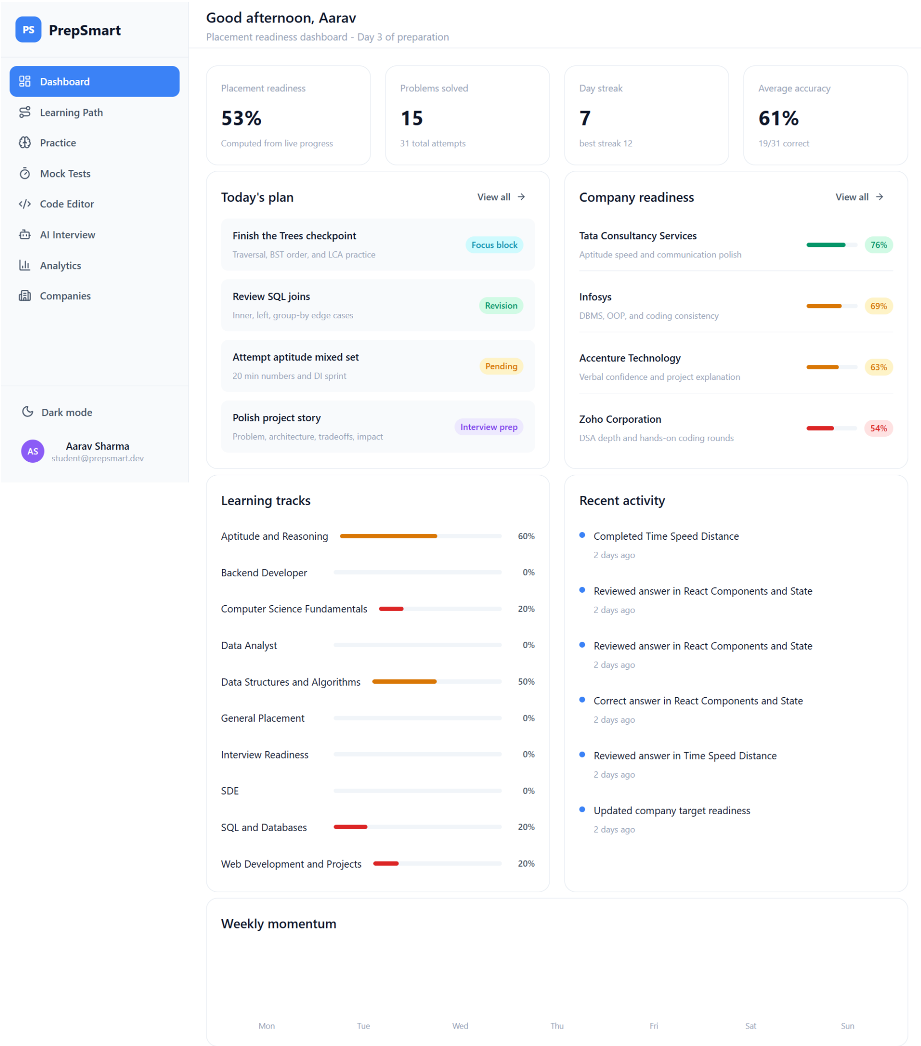


Figure 4.4: Dashboard Page - Activity.

## 4.3 Learning Path Module

The learning path module provides structured topic-wise preparation. It organizes content into tracks such as aptitude, data structures, databases, and web development.

Each track consists of multiple topics with progress indicators, allowing users to follow a systematic preparation plan. The system also highlights weak areas and suggests focus topics.

This module ensures a structured and goal-oriented learning experience.

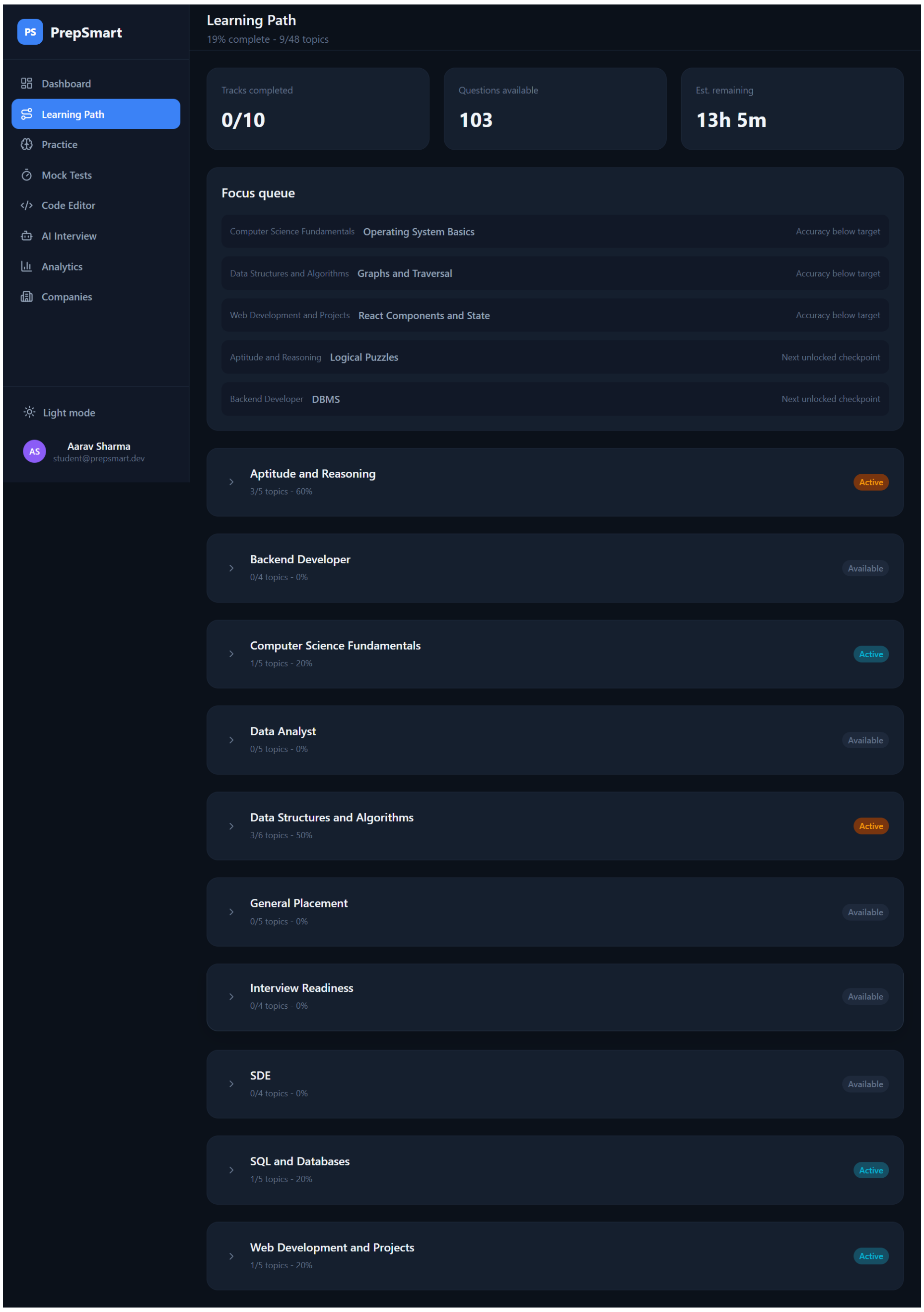


Figure 4.5: Learning Path Page - Tracks.

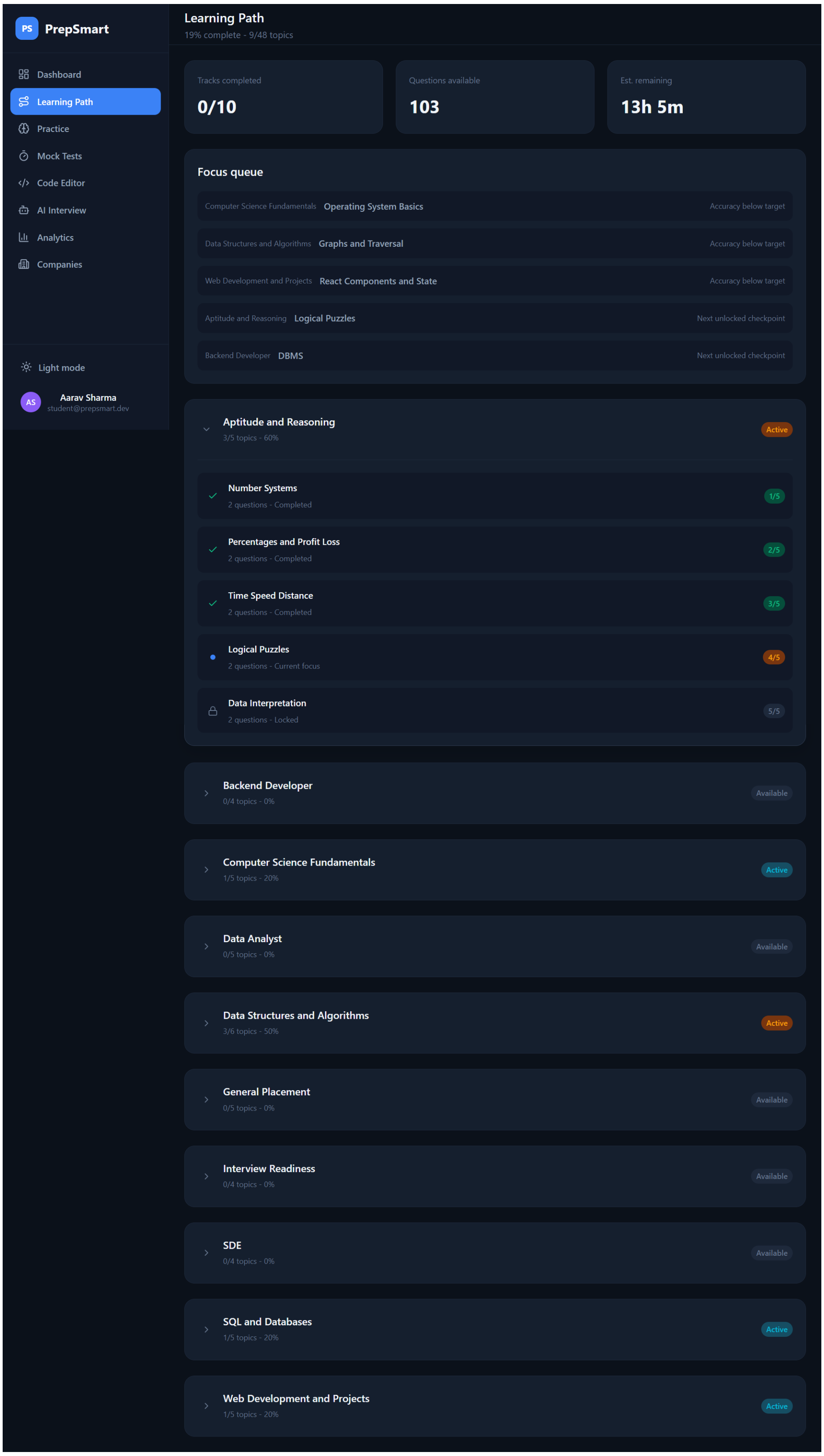


Figure 4.6: Learning Path Page - Topics.

## 4.4 Practice Module

The practice module allows users to solve topic-wise questions and improve their problem-solving skills. It provides recommended questions based on weak areas and performance.

Users can track their accuracy, number of questions solved, and progress in different topics. The system categorizes questions into different domains for better organization.

This module helps users strengthen their fundamentals through consistent practice.

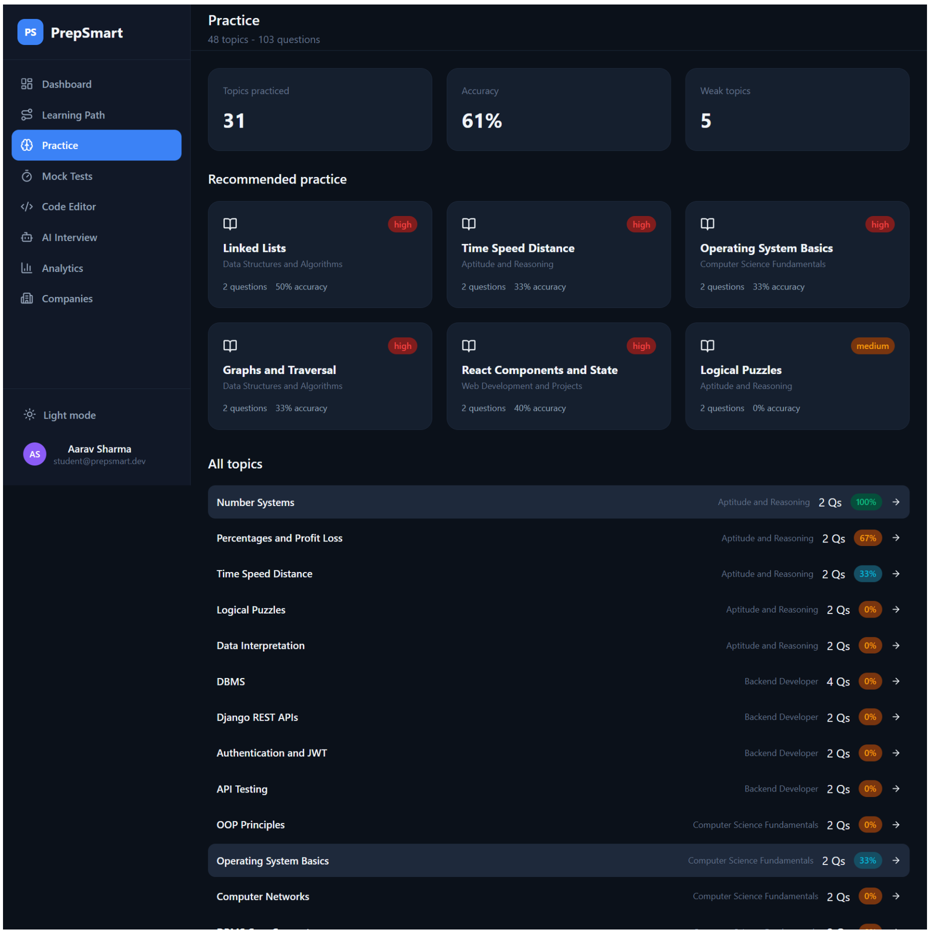


Figure 4.7: Practice Page - Domains.

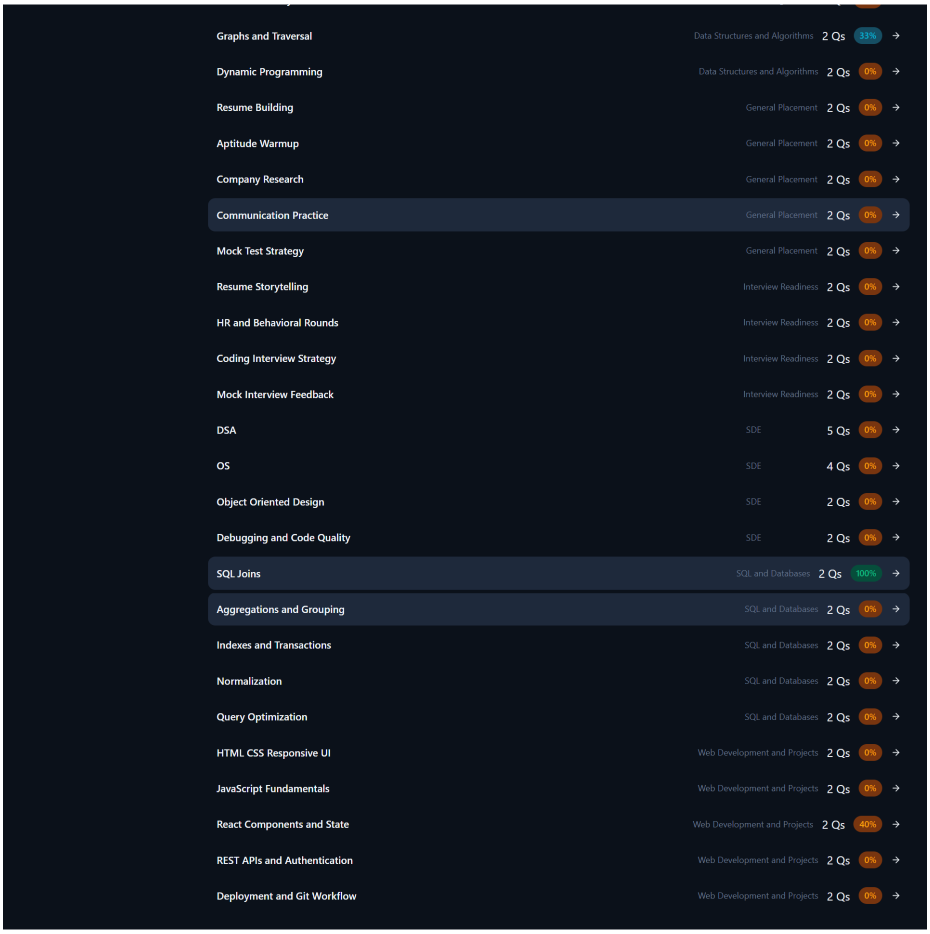


Figure 4.8: Practice Page - Questions.

## 4.5 Mock Test Module

The mock test module simulates real placement tests by providing timed assessments. It includes multiple sections such as aptitude, technical questions, and coding problems.

The system automatically evaluates user responses and provides scores and feedback. It also maintains test history for performance tracking.

This module helps users prepare under exam-like conditions and improve time management skills.

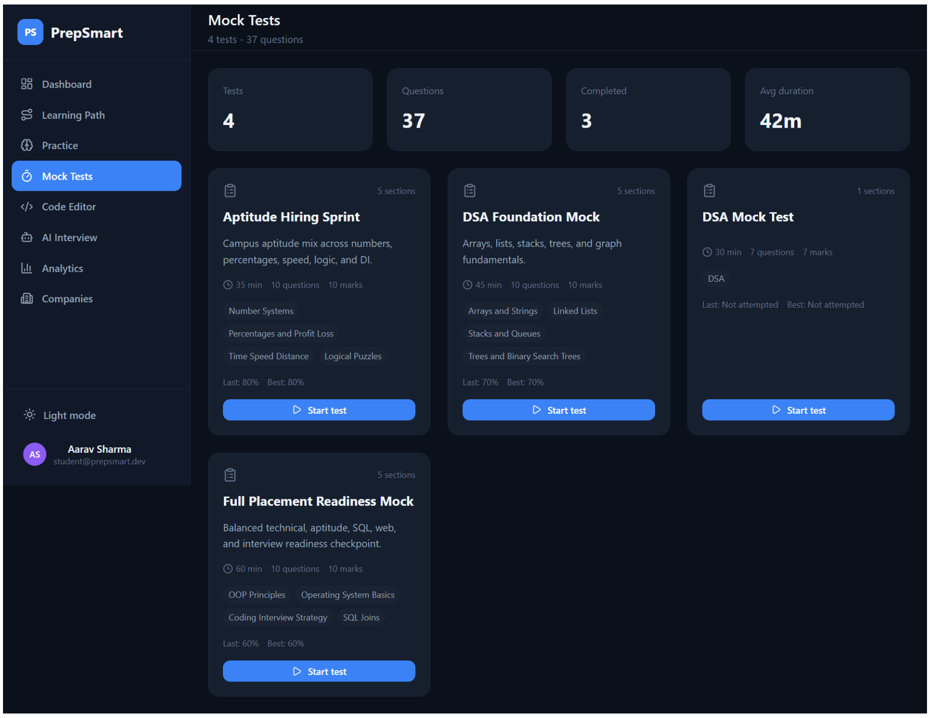


Figure 4.9: Mock Test Page - Instructions.

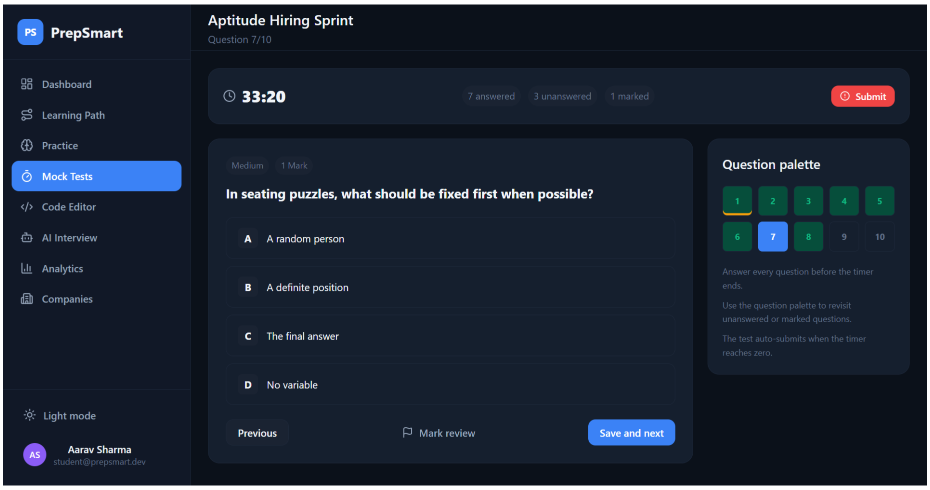


Figure 4.10: Mock Test Page - Active Assessment.

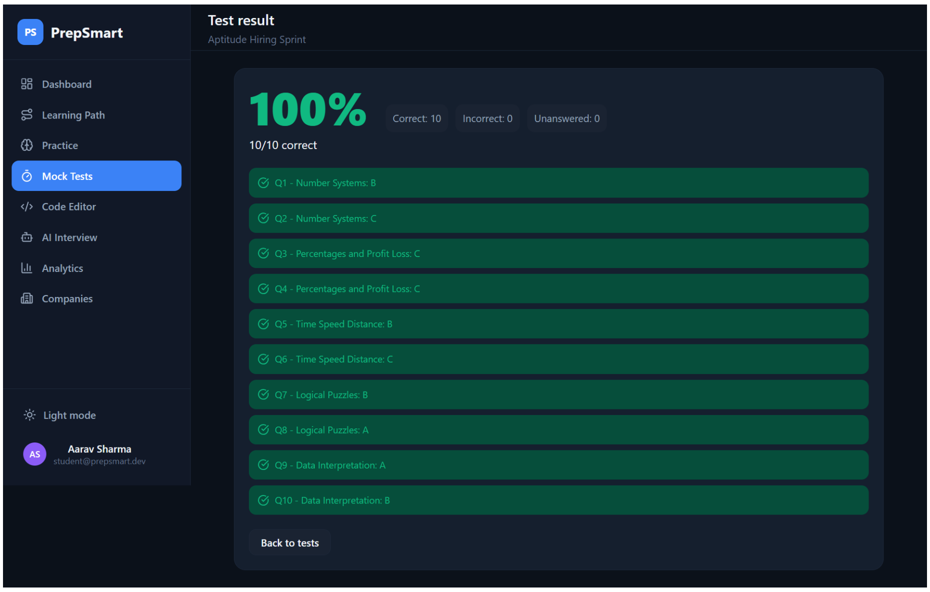


Figure 4.11: Mock Test Page - Results.

## 4.6 Code Editor Module

The code editor module provides a real-time coding environment for solving programming problems. It supports Python execution and allows users to input custom test cases.

The backend processes the code and returns the output, execution time, and errors if any. This helps users test their solutions instantly.

The module enhances coding practice by providing an integrated execution environment.

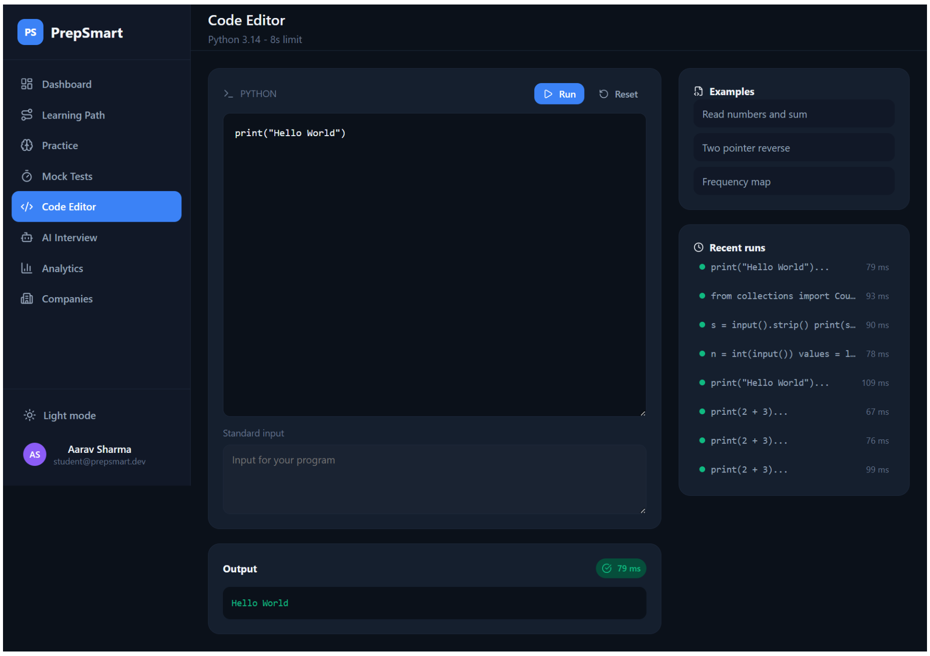


Figure 4.12: Code Editor Page.

## 4.7 AI Interview Module

The AI Interview module simulates real interview scenarios by presenting users with questions related to technical and behavioral topics.

Users can type their responses, which are evaluated based on predefined criteria. This helps improve communication skills and confidence.

The module bridges the gap between preparation and real interview experience.

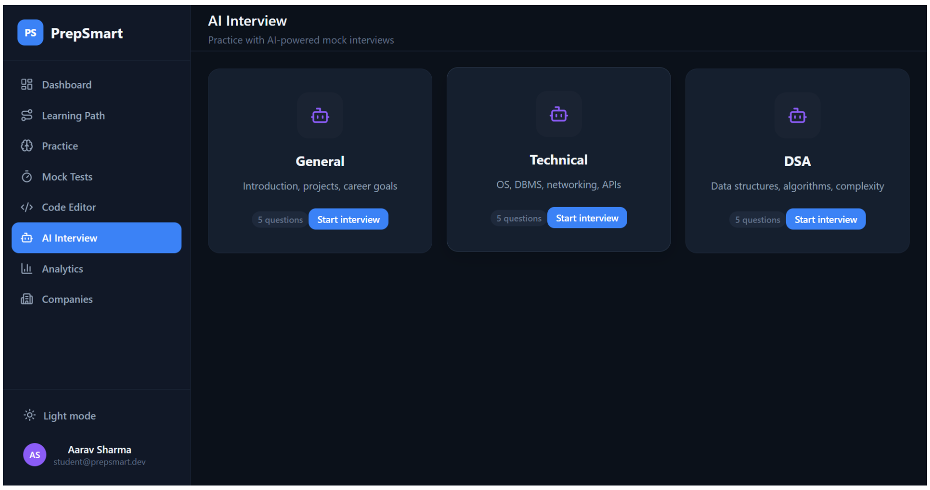


Figure 4.13: AI Interview Page - Setup.

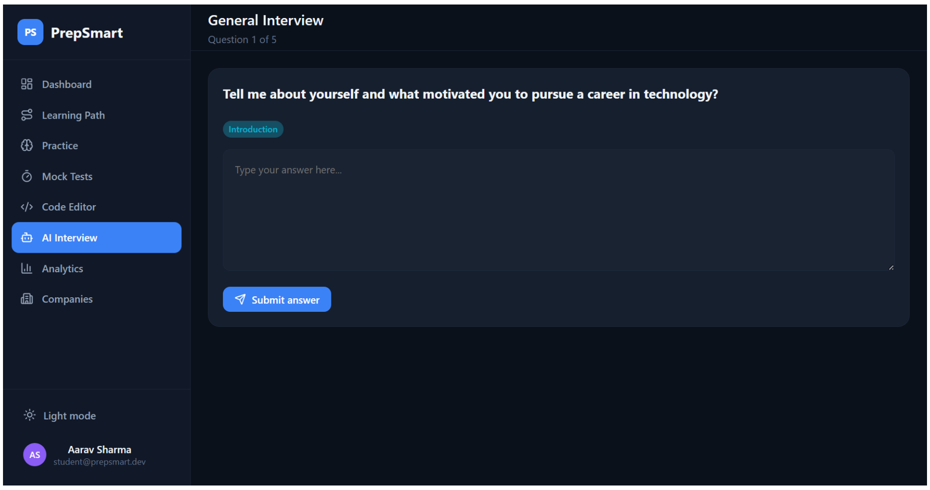


Figure 4.14: AI Interview Page - Session.

## 4.8 Analytics Module

The analytics module provides detailed insights into user performance. It displays metrics such as accuracy, total attempts, topic-wise performance, and weak areas.

Graphs and charts are used to visualize progress over time. This helps users identify areas for improvement and adjust their preparation strategy.

The analytics system is powered by backend computations and database-driven insights.

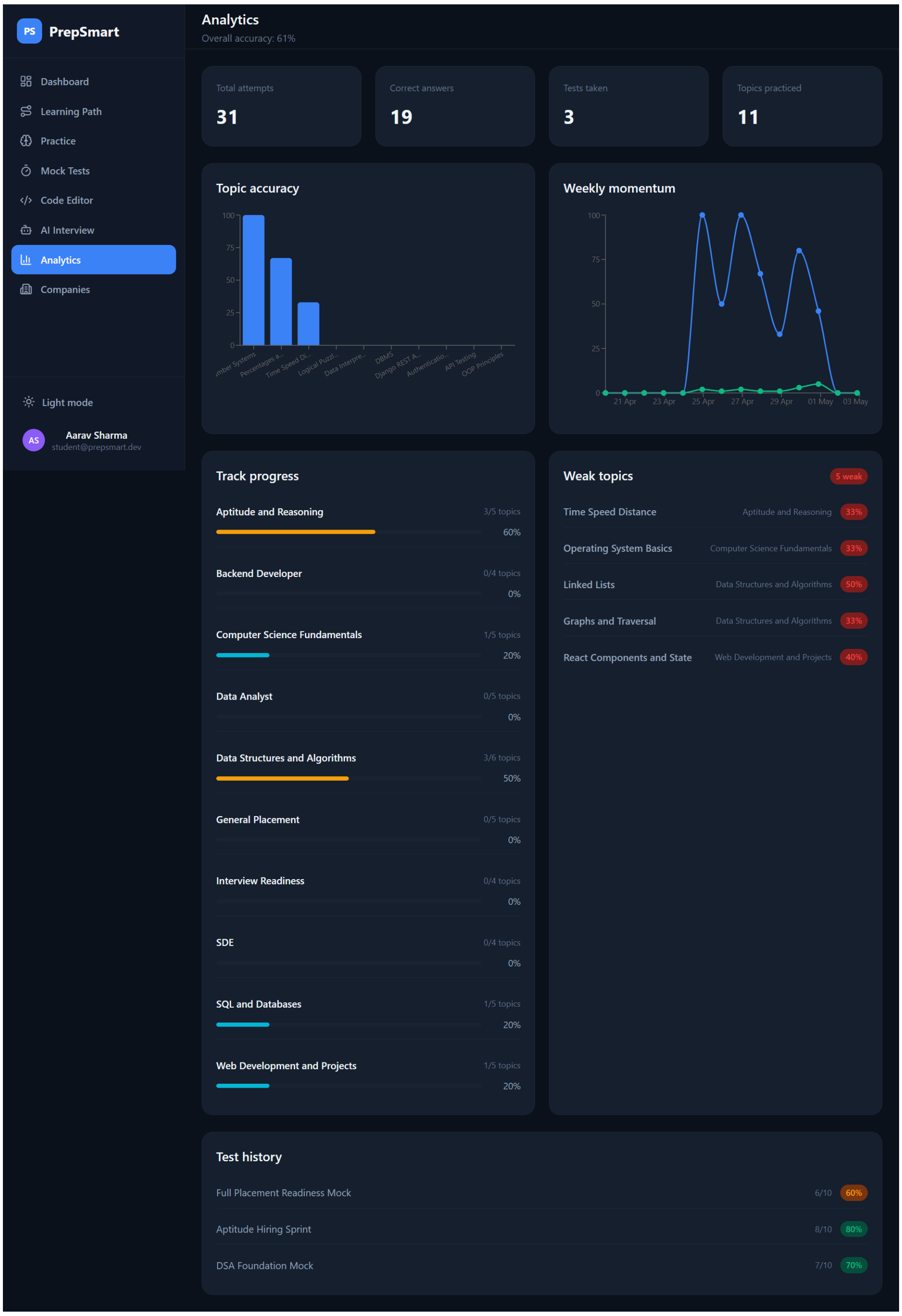


Figure 4.15: Analytics Page.

## 4.9 Company Readiness Module

The company readiness module helps users track their preparation for specific companies. It provides details such as required skills, roles, and readiness percentage.

Users can monitor their progress for each company and focus on areas that need improvement.

This module aligns preparation with real-world company requirements.

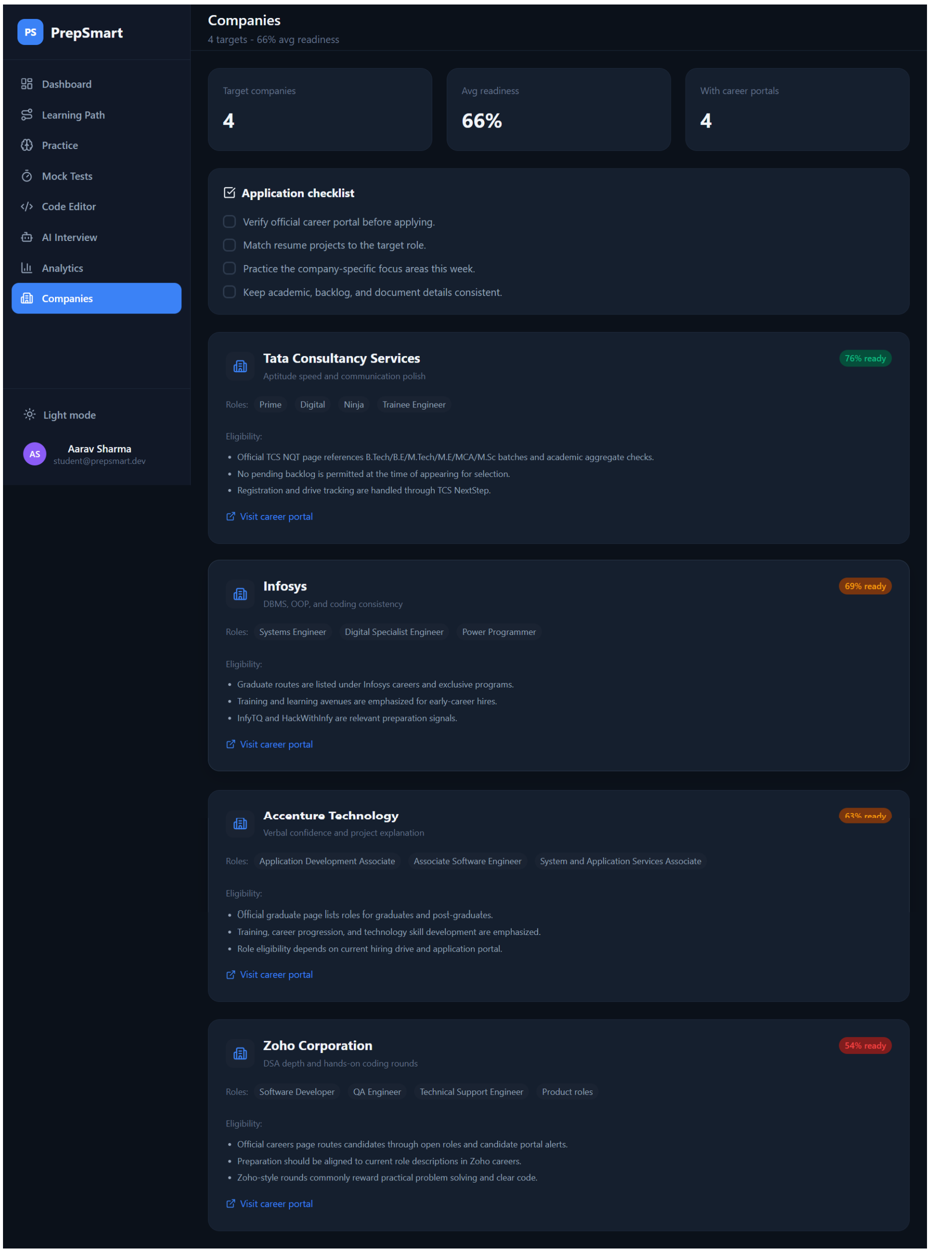


Figure 4.16: Company Readiness Page.

# Chapter 5

# Results And Discussion

## 5.1 Results

The results of the PrepSmart platform demonstrate the successful implementation of all major modules, providing an integrated and efficient placement preparation system.

The authentication module (refer to Figures 4.1 and 4.2) successfully enables secure user registration and login using JSON Web Tokens (JWT). It ensures safe access control and session management.

The dashboard module (refer to Figures 4.3 and 4.4) provides a comprehensive overview of user performance, including placement readiness, problems solved, accuracy, and daily activities. The dynamic updates confirm proper backend integration and real-time data handling.

The learning path module (refer to Figures 4.5 and 4.6) effectively organizes topics into structured tracks with progress indicators. This validates the system's ability to guide users through a systematic preparation process.

The practice module (refer to Figures 4.7 and 4.8) successfully delivers topic-wise questions and tracks user performance, including accuracy and progress. It demonstrates effective categorization and recommendation logic.

The mock test module (refer to Figures 4.9, 4.10, and 4.11) simulates real test environments with timed assessments and automatic evaluation. The system accurately calculates scores and maintains test history, ensuring realistic exam simulation.

The code editor module (refer to Figure 4.12) enables real-time Python code execution. The backend correctly processes user code and returns outputs, execution time, and error handling, confirming proper functionality.

The AI interview module (refer to Figures 4.13 and 4.14) presents interview questions and allows users to submit responses. This demonstrates the system's capability to simulate interview scenarios.

The analytics module (refer to Figure 4.15) provides detailed insights into performance through graphs, weak topic identification, and progress tracking. This confirms the effectiveness of backend-driven analytics.

## 5.2 Discussion

The overall performance of the PrepSmart platform indicates that the system operates efficiently and meets its intended objectives.

The integration of multiple modules into a single platform eliminates the need for using separate tools, thereby improving user convenience and consistency in preparation. The backend successfully handles API requests and ensures smooth communication between frontend and database.

The dashboard and analytics modules provide meaningful insights, enabling users to identify weak areas and improve their preparation strategy. The visualization of data through graphs enhances user understanding.

The mock test module effectively replicates real exam conditions, helping users develop time management skills. The automatic evaluation system ensures accurate and instant feedback.

The code execution module performs reliably, executing Python code with correct outputs and minimal delay. This validates the efficiency of backend processing.

The AI interview module adds significant value by simulating real-world interview scenarios, helping users improve communication and confidence.

Overall, the system demonstrates strong performance in terms of functionality, usability, and scalability. It successfully transforms placement preparation into a structured, data-driven, and interactive process.

# Chapter 6

# Limitations And Future Work

## 6.1 Limitations

Although the **PrepSmart platform** successfully integrates multiple features for placement preparation, it has certain limitations that can be improved in future versions.

These limitations highlight areas where the system can be further enhanced to provide a more **robust, scalable,** and **user-friendly solution**:

- **Language Support:** Currently, the system supports only **Python** in the code editor, which restricts users who prefer other programming languages such as Java or C++.
- **Deployment:** The platform operates in a **local environment** and is not deployed on a cloud server, which limits accessibility, scalability, and real-world usage.
- **AI Evaluation:** The AI Interview module performs **basic evaluation** based on predefined logic and does not use advanced natural language processing techniques, limiting the depth of feedback.
- **Admin Interface:** At present, administrative operations such as managing users, questions, tests, and content are handled through the **Django Admin Panel**, which is not directly accessible through the main user interface. This creates a dependency on backend tools instead of a fully integrated system.
- **UI/UX:** The platform lacks refinement in the **landing page design** and **user experience**, which can be improved to provide a more engaging first impression.
- **Static Content:** The system relies on **static question sets,** and **dynamic** or **adaptive** question generation is not implemented.

## 6.2 Future Work

The **PrepSmart platform** has strong potential for future enhancements and expansion. Overall, the following improvements will transform **PrepSmart** into a more intelligent, scalable, and industry-ready placement preparation ecosystem:

- **Expanded Language Support:** Support for **multiple programming languages** such as Java, C++, and JavaScript can be added to the code editor to make the platform more versatile.
- **Cloud Deployment:** The system can be deployed on **cloud platforms** to improve accessibility, scalability, and performance for real-world usage.
- **Integrated Admin Dashboard:** A major improvement would be the development of a **dedicated admin dashboard within the main application**, allowing administrators to manage users, questions, tests, and analytics directly through the platform.
- **Enhanced UI/UX:** The **landing page can be enhanced** with improved design, better content presentation, and interactive elements to create a stronger first impression and improve user engagement.
- **Advanced AI Integration:** The AI module can be significantly upgraded using **advanced Artificial Intelligence** and **Natural Language Processing (NLP)** techniques to provide deeper evaluation, personalized feedback, and intelligent recommendations.
- **Live Updates:** AI can be integrated to provide **live hiring updates, company notifications,** and **job alerts**, helping students stay informed about ongoing placement opportunities.
- **Adaptive Learning:** The system can incorporate **adaptive learning algorithms** to recommend personalized preparation paths based on user performance.
- **New Modules:** Features such as **resume analysis, company-specific preparation modules,** and **mock HR interviews** can further enhance the platform.

# Chapter 7

# Conclusion

## 7.1 Conclusion

The **PrepSmart platform** successfully addresses the challenges associated with traditional placement preparation by providing a **centralized, structured, and data-driven solution**. The system integrates multiple modules such as learning paths, practice, mock tests, code execution, AI interview simulation, and analytics into a single unified platform.

The implementation demonstrates effective use of modern technologies including **React, Django REST Framework (DRF), MySQL,** and **JSON Web Tokens (JWT)** to ensure a scalable, secure, and efficient system. The modular architecture allows seamless communication between frontend, backend, and database components.

The platform enables users to track their preparation progress, identify weak areas, and improve through continuous feedback. Features such as real-time coding, performance analytics, and interview simulation enhance both technical and communication skills.

Although certain limitations exist, such as restricted language support, dependency on the **Django Admin Panel,** and **basic AI capabilities,** the system provides a strong foundation for future enhancements. With improvements like advanced AI integration, cloud deployment, and a dedicated admin dashboard, the platform can evolve into a comprehensive industry-ready solution.

In conclusion, **PrepSmart** transforms placement preparation into a **systematic, interactive, and measurable process,** significantly improving the efficiency and effectiveness of student learning and readiness for real-world interviews.

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